REFUSAL OF THE CALL

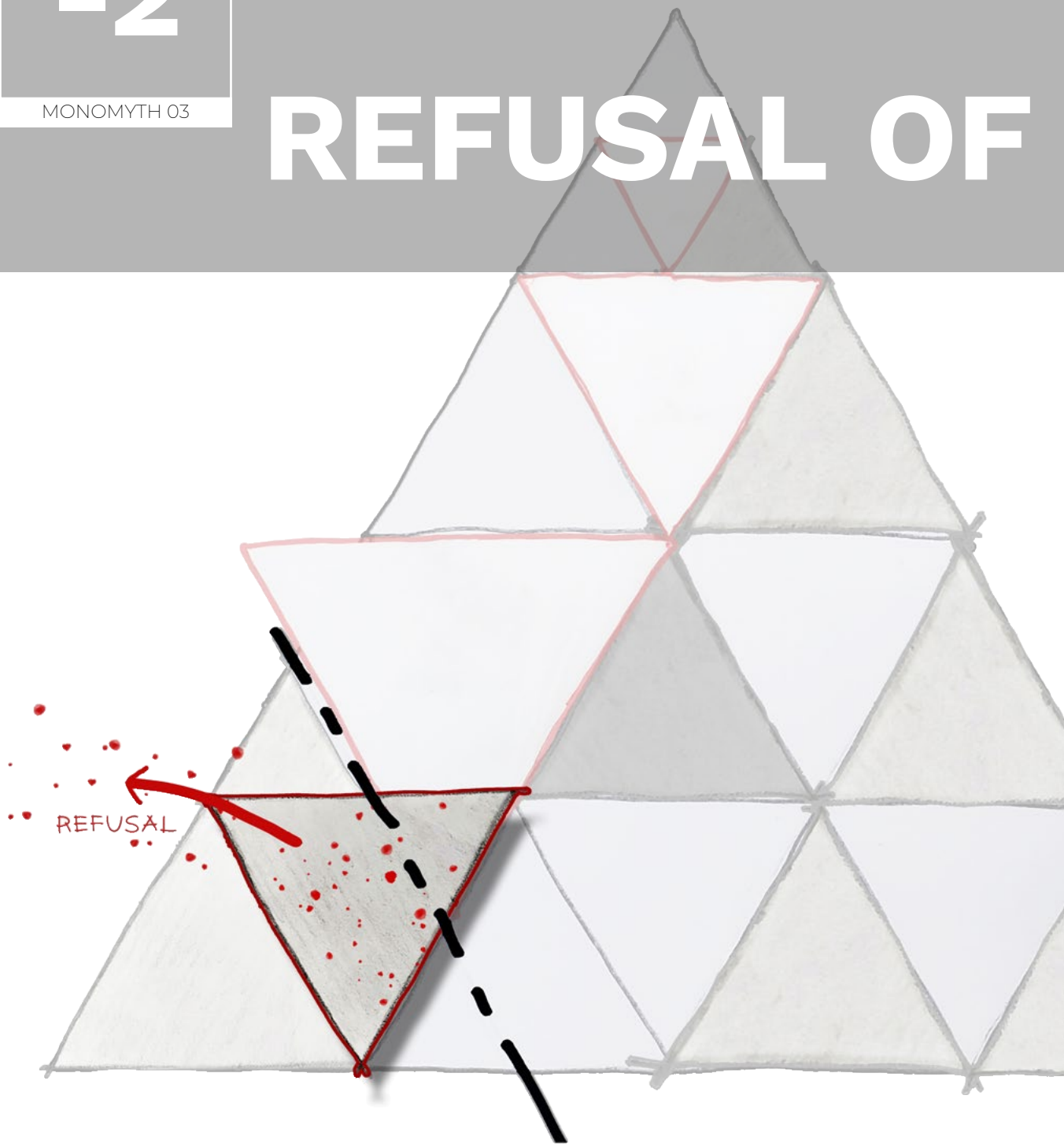
I. I walk down the trail.

There is a deep crevasse in my path.
I fall in. I am lost. I am helpless.
It isn't my fault.
It takes forever to find a way out.

-2

MONOMYTH 03

REFUSAL OF



THE CALL

"**Refusal of the Call**" is a stage in the hero's journey where the protagonist hesitates to embrace the adventure due to fear, doubt, or attachment to the familiar. Key aspects include:

Fear and Doubt: The hero struggles with fear of failure, uncertainty, and self-doubt, creating emotional barriers to accepting the call.

Clinging to Familiarity: The safety and predictability of the Ordinary World make the hero reluctant to embrace change.

Rationalization and External Influences: The hero may justify their refusal with excuses or be influenced by societal norms or protective figures discouraging the journey.

Consequences of Resistance: Refusal often leads to stagnation, dissatisfaction, or missed opportunities, as the hero risks remaining stuck in unproductive patterns.

Providential Nudges: Subtle signs or external pressures may reappear, urging the hero to reconsider and take the leap.

Universal Struggle: This stage reflects the shared human experience of grappling with fear and inertia, emphasizing that transformation begins with the courage to confront doubts and embrace the unknown.



-2 REFUSAL OF

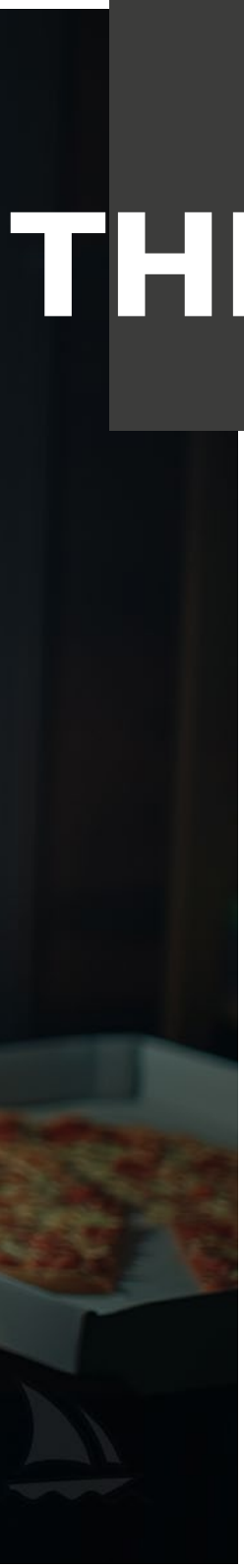
MONOMYTH 03

The Refusal of the Call—
It starts early. Protective providers intending well.
Without skinned knees we fail to recognize danger.

REFUSAL

MONOMYTH 03

THE CALL



I RARELY GOT INTO TROUBLE.

That's because I didn't have digital devices. Everything was analog - with consequences. I nearly started a forest fire. I played with REAL rifles. I learned to skid, slide, climb, run. I discovered snow and motorcycles made for lots of action downhill through the neighbors' apple orchard - as I mimicked Jean-Claude Killy. However my rich imagination wouldn't place me anywhere near my ski teammates Mark and Ben Kennedy. I didn't have a mentor, or natural talent. I believed what the impressionable do - peer criticism as fiat. I was wrong, I had no idea so were they.

The gaming industry took advantage of an entire generation like this. Rather than skinning knees, a game reset made life easier to play. This foundation doesn't prepare kids for life in the real world.

Unfortunately our son Chris chose the gaming and digital path. He followed social media and the voices of peers more than the prompting of his heart. His echo of woundings over-rode his inner voice. He died by trusting that other people would intervene to reset his game.

That's a tragic chapter in Scotomaville.



"Mom, bring pizza!" I'm in the middle of a game.

-2 ICONIC

MONOMYTH 03



The Porsche 914, particularly the 1974 model, is a classic mid-engine sports car known for its unique design and handling characteristics.

It was an icon of success, and I worked at a Shell 'service' station in high-school with the singular intention of buying one. While signing paperwork, I was asked for my insurance. Huh? The next few days were hell for me. Insurance for a high-school senior would be more than the car itself.

I was crushed. How could it be so easy for all my work and dreams to be stolen so quickly? And so, I bought a 'reasonable' Toyota, and sprinted off to the 1974 Spokane World's Fair. Spokane was the smallest city in history to host a World's Fair, but over five million people attended.

One of the night-time concert stages had a series of 'Christian' music artists. It was a packed event, and I was open to their message - answering their call to adventure at a makeshift alter. I stood there for what seemed an eternity. The band packed up and scurried off stage - and I was ignored, over-looked, invisible? ***I dunno. I missed 'The Call'.***

The second tallest dream I could imagine was in nuclear energy. I heard the Rancho Seco Nuclear Generating Station needed hard working young men, but they said I needed experience. What? Where else do I get that? The recruiter claimed I 'aced' the U.S. Navy Nuclear Power entrance exam. So there I headed, my car now in storage.

Wow, was I naive.

I hadn't directly refused my call to adventure, but the adventure I began was far more than I was prepared for. Vietnam. American Politics. War and environmental protests. Pink Floyd, and military exersizes. Walter Cronkite had turned on me. President Carter, and half of America hated us 'baby-killers'. Yeah, studying in a top secret facilitary surrounded by Marines in-arms was pretty cool - and also Top Secret. I learned really cool stuff, but it wasn't what I needed to know. I was a pawn. I'd left Nineveh, but didn't have a clue about Scotomaville - or WIDWID.

REFUSAL

MONOMYTH 03

"**Refusal of the Call**" is a stage in the hero's journey where the protagonist hesitates to embrace the adventure due to fear, doubt, or attachment to the familiar. Key aspects include:

Fear and Doubt: uncertainty, and self-doubt, creating emotional barriers to accepting the call.

Clinging to Familiarity: safety and predictability make the hero reluctant to embrace change.

External Influences: influenced by societal norms or influences discouraging the journey.

Consequences: leads to stagnation, dissatisfaction, or missed opportunities.

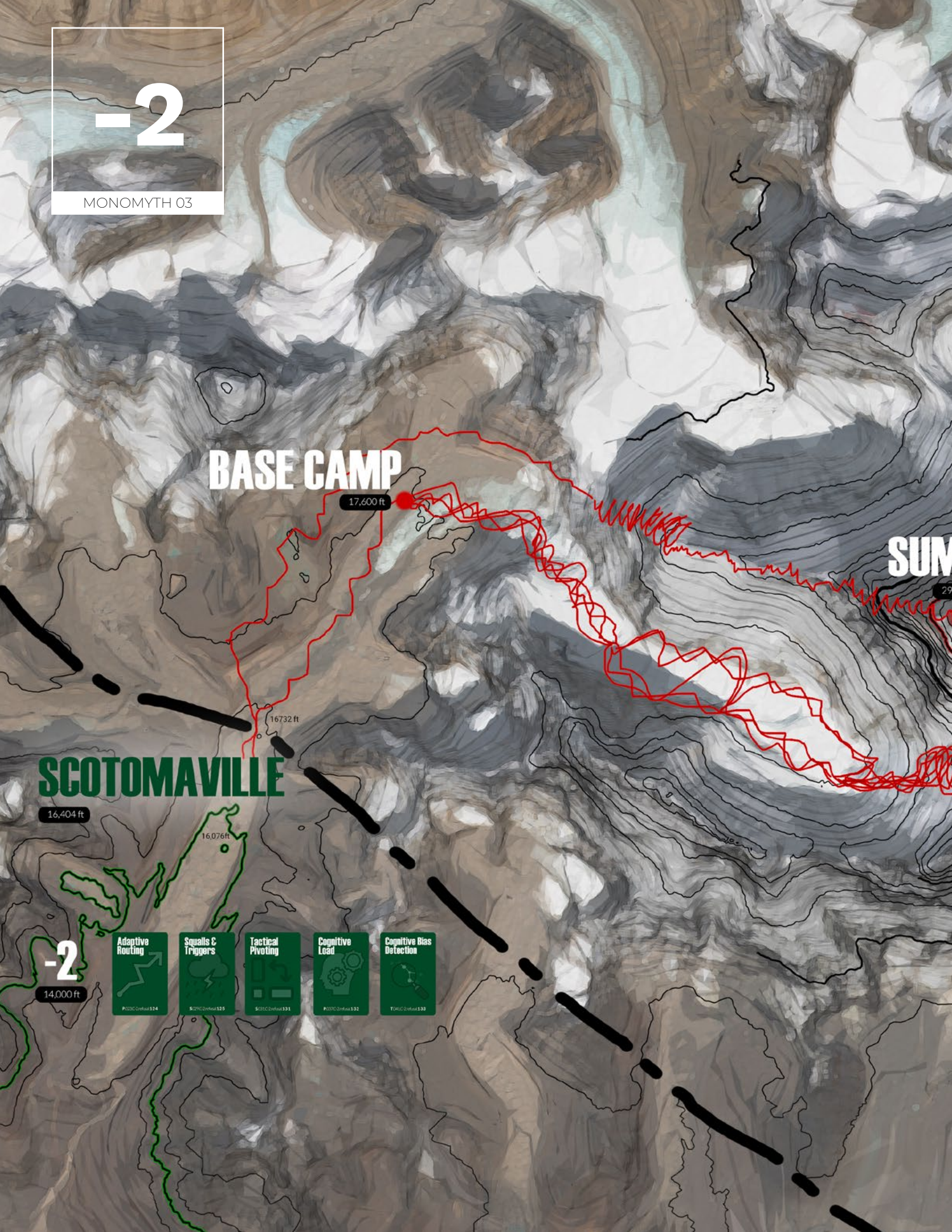
Providential Nudges: pressures may reappear, urging the hero to reconsider and take the leap.

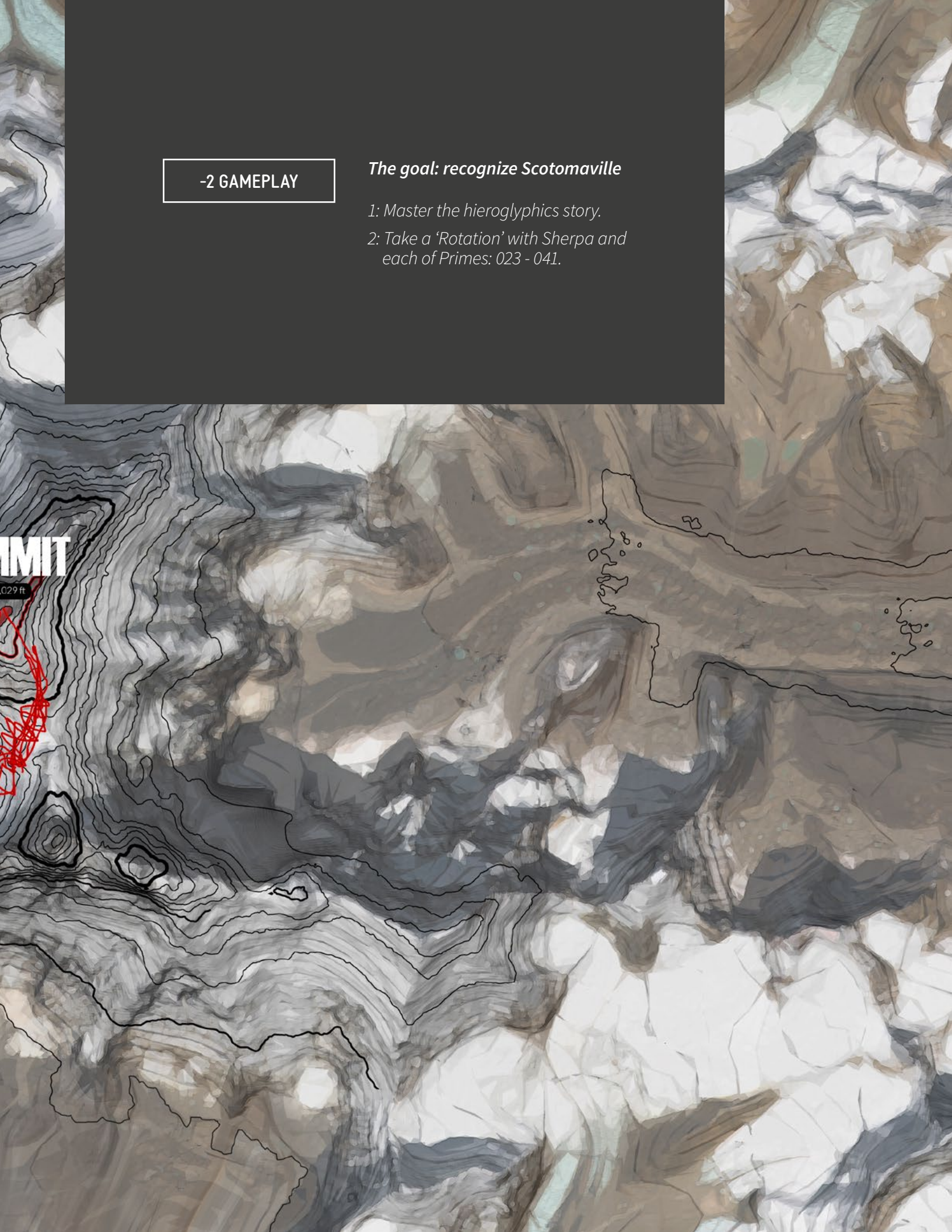
Universal Struggle: transformation begins with embracing the unknown.

- *"Cheap grace is the preaching of forgiveness without requiring repentance... Costly grace is the treasure hidden in the field; for the sake of it a man will go and sell all that he has."*
  Dietrich Bonhoeffer

- *"If you look for truth, you may find comfort in the end; if you look for comfort, you will not get either comfort or truth."*
  C.S. Lewis- Mere Christianity, 1952

- *"A Wolf found great difficulty in getting at the sheep owing to the vigilance of the shepherd and his dogs. But one day it found the skin of a sheep that had been flayed and thrown aside, so it put it on over its own pelt and strolled down among the sheep. The Lamb that belonged to the sheep, whose skin the Wolf was wearing, began to follow the Wolf in the Sheep's clothing; so, leading the Lamb a little apart, he soon made a meal off her, and for some time he succeeded in deceiving the sheep, and enjoying hearty meals.* ***Moral: Appearances are deceptive.****"*
  Aesop's The Wolf in Sheep's Clothing


-2
MONOMYTH 03
BASE CAMP
17,600 ft
16732 ft
SCOTOMAVILLE
16,404 ft
16,076ft
-2
14,000 ft
Adaptive Routing
Squalls & Triggers
Tactical Pivoting
Cognitive Load
Cognitive Bias Detection



-2 GAMEPLAY

The goal: recognize Scotomaville

1: Master the hieroglyphics story.

2: Take a 'Rotation' with Sherpa and each of Primes: 023 - 041.

Adaptive Routing



DEFINITION:

In the journey of AI Self-Mastery, Adaptive Routing is the art of charting a flexible path, inspired by the sailing technique of tacking—zigzagging to move upwind—and the Stoic practice of pivoting around obstacles. It teaches Explorers to see challenges not as dead ends but as signals to shift direction, ensuring steady progress even when the way forward isn't straight. This principle fosters mental agility and resilience, turning every detour into a step closer to your Personal Everest.

360MEN: WTA 10 - KNOW FEAR:

"It seems there is a huge distinction between 'NO fear' and 'KNOW fear'. Carry a load that challenges you without crushing you. Get help out of the crevasse and have another Rotation up your personal Everest."

PAIRS WITH:

Strategies: *Links to Self-Reflection (for monitoring strain) and Incremental Change Thinking (for building capacity over time).*

Tools: *Enhanced by AI Sherpa's Pack (to offload mental tasks) and Checkpoint (to gauge load at key intervals).*

Wildcards: *Connects to Providential Constraints Analysis, reframing limits as chances to streamline.*

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

In leaving Nineveh, when doubts resist the Call, Adaptive Routing invites providential pivots from timeless guides. Aesop's humble fable, Edison's inventive persistence, and Matthew's divine yoke reveal flexibility over rigidity, turning obstacles into growth paths.

- *Aesop's The Oak and the Reeds shows a proud oak uprooted by storm while flexible reeds survive by bending.* Moral: **"Better to yield and endure than to resist and perish,"** *urging gentle adaptation to forces beyond control.*
- **"When you have exhausted all possibilities, remember this: you haven't."** Thomas Edison
  Thomas Edison affirms in his inventive trials where pivots amid failures sparked breakthroughs, bridging resolve to resilient innovation. How might this guide you now?
- Matthew 11:28-30 invites: **"Come to me, all you who are weary... my yoke is easy,"** *offering divine rest through humble surrender, turning burdensome routes into providential peace and ultimate strength.*

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *You plan your way forward in self-mastery. Blocks appear along the route. Adaptive routing lets you adjust your direction. You see these blocks as signs to change course. You draw ideas from sailors who zigzag against the wind. You also learn from speedsters who go around tough spots. This keeps your progress steady. You build mental strength and the ability to shift.*

APPLICATION:

Practical Step:

In Daniel's Cairn, this plays out vividly—the "KNOW FEAR" sticker on the pursuing 911 serves as a providential nudge, transforming pressure into a checkpoint for self-awareness and steady ascent. It's a call to embrace change without force, fostering mental agility in the Refusal of the Call stage.

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Misconception: *You might think Adaptive Routing means you're quitting or not committed, like a climber turning back because it's too hard. It can seem like weakness or failure to pivot, especially if you've invested time in the original route.*

Mitigation: *It's not quitting - it's rerouting for success. Like a climber who sees a storm and shifts to a safer ledge, focus on the end goal. Start small: Ask yourself, "What's one tiny adjustment that keeps me moving forward?" This builds trust in the process, turning fear into confidence.*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:

The yellow 911 behind me was pushing me beyond my skills. I knew this from my grip on the steering wheel. It seemed he was 'testing' my resolve by staying mere inches off my bumper. The 'KNOW FEAR' sticker across his rear window was only visible for a moment, but his message was loud and clear. And now I pass it to you! ***KNOW FEAR***



Squalls & Triggers



S.029.C-2.refusal.1·2·5

PAIRS WITH:

Principles:

Links to Awareness (for clear perception of emotional states) and Know Thyself (for understanding personal triggers over time).

Tools:

Enhanced by Emotional Vocabulary (to articulate feelings precisely) and Checkpoint (to gauge emotional states at key intervals).

Wildcards:

Connects to Hidden Scotoma Challenge, reframing blind spots as opportunities to uncover hidden triggers.

DEFINITION:

A strategic method where the Explorer acts as their own emotional barometer, spotting sudden reactions (squalls) and tracing their root causes (triggers) to maintain clarity and control. Like a climber reading the skies and knowing the terrain, this approach ensures you're prepared for emotional storms and can navigate them with resilience by learning from meltdowns and outbursts of the past.

SCOTOMAVILLE 02.10 SQUALLS:

"Three years ago, I tackled Squalls & Triggers—a raw dive into the storms of emotional outbursts and the hidden triggers that spark them. Knowing WIDWID (Why I Do What I Do) is like a climber forensicizing a fall: mapping the visceral 'yelp' that lashes out at allies and peers, exposing coping mechanisms carved from past wounds. This video captures what I thought I knew then—a first step toward spotting squalls before they strike, charting a steadier path up my Personal Everest.."

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

Where doubts resist the Call, Squalls & Triggers invites providential navigation of emotional storms from timeless guides. Aesop's cautionary fable, Frankl's resilient insight, and James' divine perseverance reveal restraint over reactivity, turning upheavals into growth.

- *Aesop's The Bald Man and the Fly depicts a man slapping himself to swat a biting fly, only injuring himself as it escapes.* **Moral: "You will only injure yourself if you take notice of despicable enemies,"** *urging gentle pause before reactive triggers.*
- **"Between stimulus and response, there is a space. In that space is our power to choose our response"** Viktor Frankl *affirms in Man's Search for Meaning, where camp trials taught choice amid suffering, bridging awareness to empowered diffusion.*

James 1:2-8 exhorts: **"Consider it pure joy... when you face trials... the testing of your faith produces perseverance,"** *promising wisdom for the steadfast, turning double-minded doubt into mature stability through asking.*

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *Imagine you're a mountaineer, and the weather shifts without warning. Squalls & Triggers is like reading the skies—spotting emotional storms before they overwhelm you. By pinpointing triggers, you brace for the squalls, staying steady on your path.*

Actionability:
When a strong emotion surges, pause and ask, "What's the trigger?" Trace it to its root—a memory, fear, or need. This awareness lets you respond deliberately, not react impulsively.

APPLICATION:

Practical Step:
Take the TRASH out to the dumpster. Think about the squall's trigger, your reaction, and one insight. Patterns will emerge, equipping you to handle future storms—like a climber charting weather trends you will become prepared before it hits!

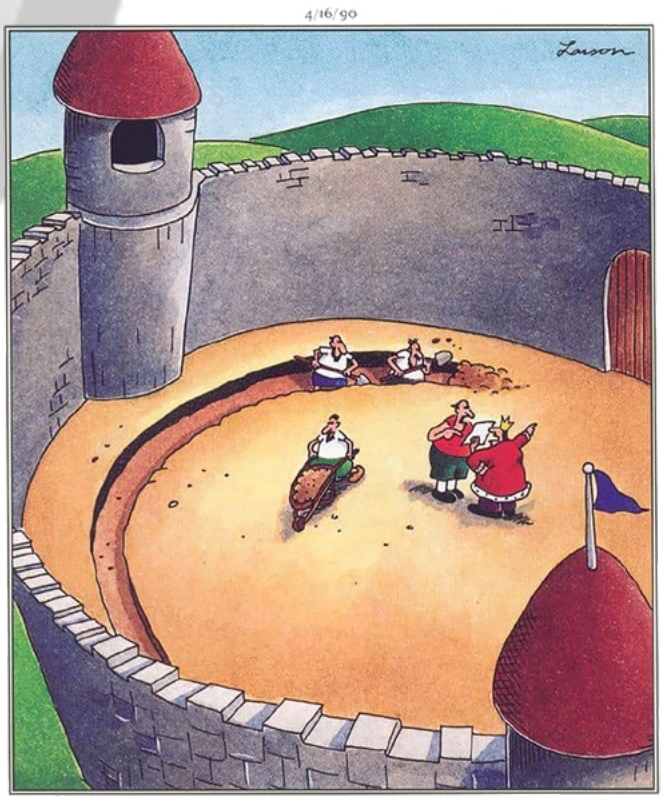
Mindset Shift:
*Shift from "***%@&!!_^***" to an emotional phrase like "I'm overwhelmed", and then to "I can forecast my emotional weather and respond before I react.*

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Misconception: *Some might think this suppresses emotions.*

Mitigation: *It's about understanding, not stifling—like a climber respecting a storm while still ascending. Honor your feelings; stay in control - expand your emotional vocabulary.*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:



Suddenly, a heated exchange took place between the King and the moat contractor.

Tactical Pivoting



S.031.C-2.refusal.1-3-1

DEFINITION:

Tactical Pivoting is the art of making intentional adjustments to your path when faced with obstacles, ensuring steady progress toward your ultimate goal. Think of a mountaineer navigating around a crevasse—adapting cleverly while keeping the summit in view.

AI SELF MASTERY COURSE TEASER:

"Pivoting does NOT mean you will immediately orient yourself with the summit. It simply means that you'll STOP climbing a dead end. I produced this video over a year ago. It demonstrates a tacktical pivot half way to what you are reading now. Remember Blaise Pascal: "follow in the way I began."

PAIRS WITH:

Principles: *Adaptive Routing (P.023.C00.refusal) - Supports flexible navigation around obstacles.*

Cognitive Load (P.037.C00.refusal) - Helps manage mental effort during pivots..

Tools: *Checkpoint (T.223.C03.testing) - Assesses the effectiveness of a pivot.*

AI Sherpa's Pack (T.347.C04.ordeal) - Offloads mental tasks during adjustments.

Wildcards: *Providential Constraints Analysis (W.433.C06.ordeal) - Reframes obstacles as opportunities for innovation.*

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

Tactical Pivoting invites providential shifts from timeless guides. Aesop's gentle persuasion, Earhart's bold action, and Jonah's divine redirection reveal swift turns into notable and unexpected outcomes.

- *Aesop's The Wind and the Sun shows the harsh Wind failing while the warm Sun persuades a traveler to shed his cloak.* **Moral: "Kindness effects more than severity,"** *urging a gentle tactical shift over forceful resistance.*
- **"The most effective way to do it is to do it,"** Amelia Earhart *asserts in Last Flight (1937), where bold pivots mid-flight overcame obstacles, bridging determination to actionable adaptation. However this does NOT ALWAYS work out well.*
- **Jonah's Flight and Pivot** (Jonah 1-3) *narrates his initial refusal to Nineveh, a storm, and whale-driven shift to obedience, escalating from denial to acceptance in a HIGH prophetic call, turning flight into providential purpose.*

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *Picture yourself sailing toward a shore when the wind shifts. You tack—adjusting your sails to harness the change. Tactical Pivoting is that mindset: instead of battling obstacles head-on, you find a new angle to keep moving forward.*

Actionability:
Hit a setback? List three possible pivots. Choose one that aligns with your goal but adapts to the situation—like a climber finding a fresh grip when one slips. *Advance to Camp 03 for a case study illustrating Tactical Pivoting with AI.*

Alignment with AISM Mission:

Structured Reasoning: *Logically assesses constraints and obstacles to devise creative solutions.*

Self-Reflection:
Challenges rigidity, fostering flexibility.

AI-Human Collaboration: *Leverages AI Sherpa to suggest alternative paths or analyze past pivots.*

APPLICATION:

Practical Step:
Encounter a roadblock? Brainstorm three adjustments. Pick the most effective—like a climber testing new footholds—then act and refine as needed!

Mindset Shift:
Move from "This isn't working" to "How can I make it work differently?" Pivots aren't retreat; they're progress in disguise.

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Misconception: *Pivoting might feel like giving up.*

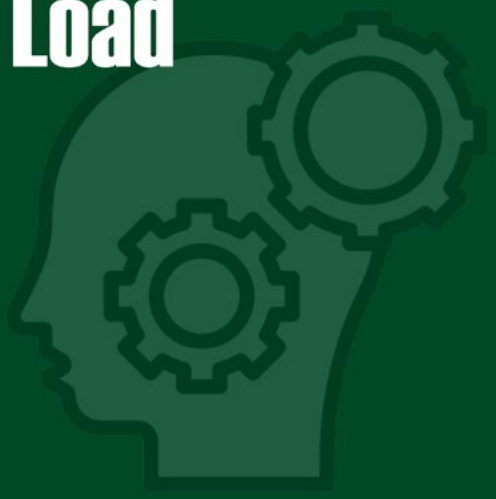
Mitigation: *It's a strategic choice, not surrender—akin to a sailor tacking to reach the destination faster. Stay committed, just smarter.*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:



"Well, *this* isn't very promising."

Cognitive Load



P.037.C-2.refusal.1·3·2

DEFINITION:

Cognitive Load refers to the total mental effort exerted in working memory to process information, solve problems, or acquire new skills. In the context of self-mastery, managing cognitive load is crucial for sustaining clarity, enhancing focus, and fostering personal growth without tipping into exhaustion - or worse - triggering with rage!

SCOTOMAVILLE V1.11 REFLECTION GUT HEALTH:

There's a large connection between gut health and cognitive load. Clear thinking can be as simple as getting the right bugs in your belly. The challenge ahead is to gain clarity, wellness, and ascend with confidence in the midst of rapidly accelerating change.

PAIRS WITH:

Strategies:

Links to Self-Reflection (for monitoring strain) and Incremental Change Thinking (for building capacity over time).

Tools: *Enhanced by AI Sherpa's Pack (to offload mental tasks) and Checkpoint (to gauge load at key intervals).*

Wildcards: *Connects to Providential Constraints Analysis, reframing limits as chances to streamline.*

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

Mental fog results in overlooked shade, simplicity, and direction. Mastering one's cognitive load is mindful pruning—honoring limits. Here we learn from Aesop's travelers, Einstein's elegance, and Luke's gardener.

- Aesop's **The Travelers and the Plane Tree** *depicts weary souls grumbling under a fruitless tree, blind to its shade.* **Moral: "Blessings are often ignored in our complaints,"** *gently urging recognition of relief amid mental clutter.*
- **"Any fool can make things more complex… It takes a touch of genius to move in the opposite direction,"** Albert Einstein *teaches, where stripping complexity birthed breakthroughs, bridging intellect to streamlined focus.*
- **The Barren Fig Tree** (Luke 13:6-9) *shares a gardener's plea for time to revive a fruitless tree, embodying providential patience, turning excessive load into a chance for fruitful growth. How might pruning your mental load help?*

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *Picture Cognitive Load as the weight in your backpack on a mountain ascent. Pack too much, and you're bogged down by fatigue; pack too little, and you lack essentials for the journey. The goal is to carry a load that challenges you without crushing you.*

Actionability:
Explorers can lighten their cognitive load by breaking complex tasks into manageable pieces—akin to a climber advancing camp by camp. Prioritizing key steps, simplifying where possible, and offloading tasks (to AI Sherpa) keeps the mind sharp.

APPLICATION:

Practical Step:
Before diving into a daunting task, jot down all its components. Then, split them into bite-sized chunks and tackle one at a time—like focusing on the next foothold instead of the distant peak.

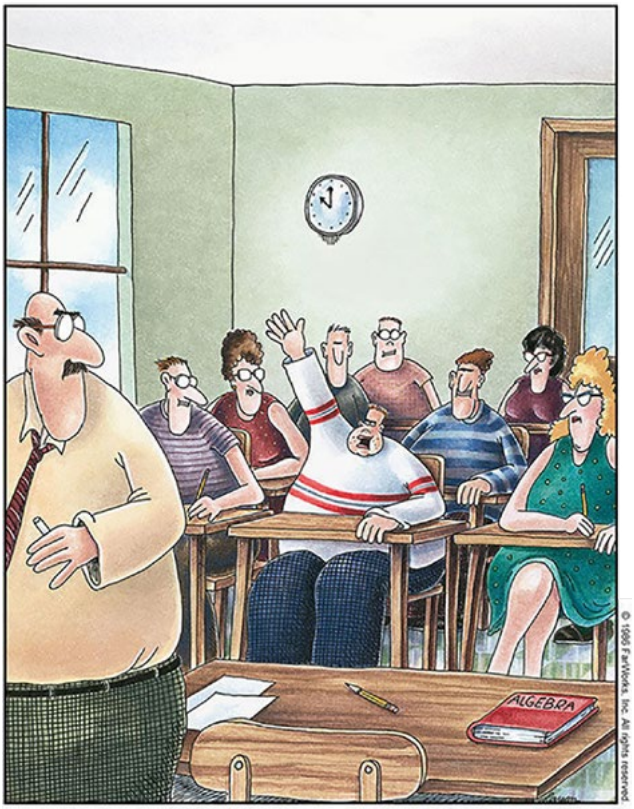
Mindset Shift:
Replace "I must juggle everything at once" with "I have a Sherpa and I can pace my effort step by step." This reframing and AI clarifying advocacy turns chaos into a steady climb.

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Misconception: *Some may assume managing cognitive load means dodging tough tasks entirely.*

Mitigation: *Emphasize that it's about optimizing effort—like a climber pacing themselves for endurance, not avoiding the mountain.*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:



"Mr. Osborne, may I be excused? My brain is full."

Cognitive Bias Detection



T.041.C-2.refusal.1·3·3

PAIRS WITH:

Principles: *Popular Vs True (P.003.C00.ordinary): Distinguishes between popular opinion and objective reality, reducing conformity bias.*

Truth Over Comfort (P.019.C00.call): Prioritizes objective truth over emotional comfort, aiding unbiased analysis.

Strategies: *Self-Reflection (S.067.C00.mentors): Encourages introspection to identify personal biases.*

Pattern Recognition (S.043.C00.mentors): Helps spot recurring biases in decision-making.

Wildcards: *Hidden Scotoma Challenge (W.409.C06.ordeal): Sherpa infers and highlights unseen cognitive or emotional blind spots—like a guide spotting a crevasse you didn't see.*

DEFINITION:

Reduce thinking distortions by reviewing the Cognitive Bias Cheat Sheet, or prompting Sherpa to explain how to reduce distortions in thinking and improve objective decision-making - like dropping empty oxygen bottles at the next depot rather than lugging waste to the top of the mountain!

SV REFLECTION V1.06 PHARAOH'S STORY:

"We're constantly gamed and offered walled gardens that confirm our cognitive biases. We're data creators freely giving our deepest promptings to supercomputers to recommend for us. We're betrayed by our biology, believing we're on track. But are we?"

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

Like correcting an inverted map, errors and facts converge in this first Tool of the Monomyth. Cognitive Bias Detection aims to unveil truth by revealing illusions for what they are. Apply Lewis's parable, Rogers' insight, and Luke's parable to move away from distortion.

- A C.S. Lewis-Style Parable: **The Reluctant Explorer's Inverted Map** *portrays a hesitant climber, map skewed by overconfidence, until a Sherpa reveals true contours.* **Moral: "As hidden crevasses demand vigilance, this AI Tool turns scotomas into light,"** *gently exposing biases for the climb.*

- **"The facts are always friendly, every bit of evidence one can acquire,"** Carl Rogers *asserts in On Becoming a Person (1961), where embracing evidence dissolves illusions, bridging awareness to honest reflection.*

- Luke 14:16-25 *narrates a feast where guests reject divine invitation for worldly excuses, urging a HIGH shift from distraction to acceptance. This parable highlights the dangers of prioritizing other things over responding to one's Call to Adventure.* ***What illusion has inverted your internal map?***

WHEN TO USE IT:

- When making significant decisions, like choosing a path up the mountain.
- During team discussions to avoid groupthink or overconfidence on the climb.
- While reflecting on past climbs to identify patterns of bias that tripped you up.
- When you feel stuck, as if fog has clouded your judgment on the trail.
- Before a big push, ensuring your mental gear is free of distortions.

Why It Matters: *Full commitment includes knowing our first thoughts are 100% wrong 50% of the time. Cognitive Bias Detection is like checking our gear for faults - like confirmation bias (favoring familiar paths) or anchoring (sticking to the first trail you see) can lead you astray. Use this tool often.*

HOW TO USE IT:

1. **Draw the Cognitive Bias Cheat Sheet**: Pause at each quadrant to consider hidden biases.
2. **Prompt Sherpa**: Ask, "Sherpa, is there bias in my decision to camp here despite the storm warning?"
3. **Analyze the response**: Dig for biases like availability heuristic (over-relying on recent sunny days).
4. **Adjust Your Approach**: Shift your plan based on the insight - maybe choose a safer location or route.

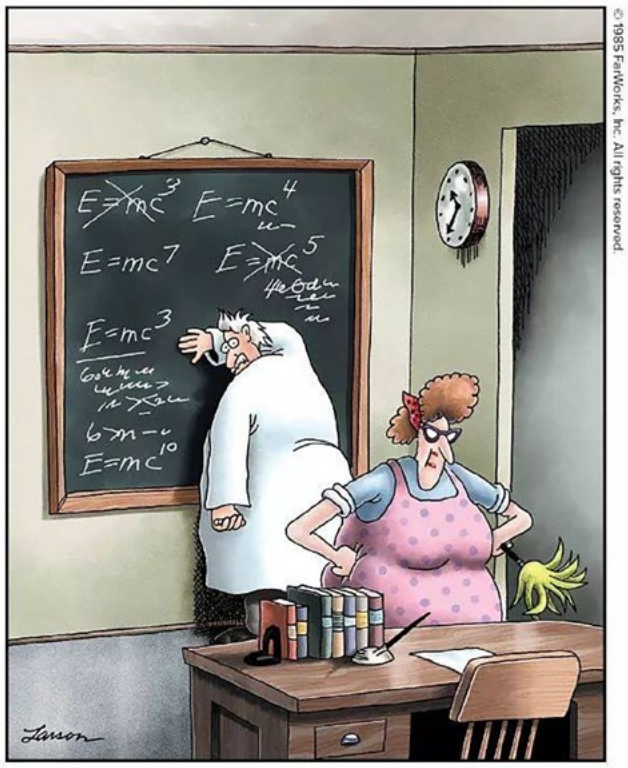
Parable*: Imagine a climber, eager to summit, who always takes the sunlit path because it feels safe. One day, he ignores a storm warning, thinking, "It's been sunny all week!" Cognitive Bias Detection is the compass that warns him: "Don't expect only sunlight - check the shadows." It's a first step to seeing the mountain as it truly is.*

PRACTICE CHALLENGE:

For one week, analyze a daily decision using Cognitive Bias Detection - whether it's choosing a meal, replying to a message, or planning your day. Ask Sherpa to identify biases unnoticed in your choice. Journal your reflections, noting how biases clouded your thinking and how correcting them changed your outcome. By week's end, you'll have a clearer view of your mental terrain, like a climber who's learned to spot crevasses before they fall in.

Teaching Moment*: This challenge isn't just about catching biases - it's about building a habit of awareness. Learning to question our assumptions is a skill that can avoid pitfalls when the storms hit on the mountain.*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:



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"*Now* that desk looks better. Everything's squared away, yessir, squaaaaaared away."